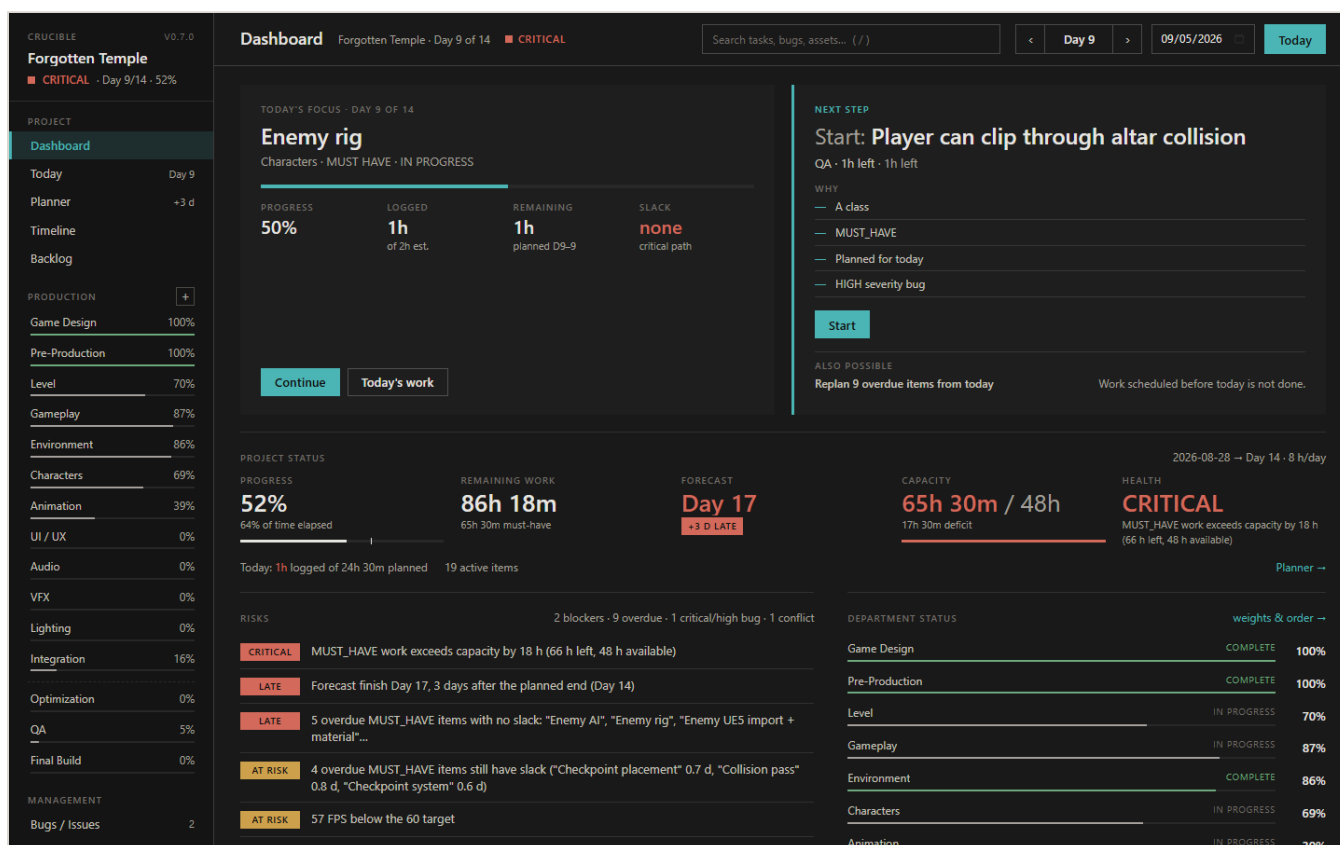


Crucible

Independent project tracking and bug tracking for game developers and 3D artists. One person, one plan, every day.



Local, offline desktop app for Windows. No account, no cloud; your data stays in files on your PC.
This manual covers Crucible 0.7 (September 2026).

Contents

- | | | | |
|-----------|--|-----------|---|
| 1 | What Crucible is | 13 | Search |
| 2 | Install and first launch | 14 | Time log |
| 3 | The window: rail, header, shortcuts | 15 | Reports |
| 4 | The ideas behind it (read this once) | 16 | Project Settings and the New Project wizard |
| 5 | Dashboard | 17 | A normal working day |
| 6 | Today | 18 | Your data: where it lives, backups, sharing |
| 7 | The item window (tasks and bugs) | 19 | Questions and answers |
| 8 | Departments | 20 | Feature checklist |
| 9 | Adding a department and the next-step engine | 21 | Several projects |
| 10 | Planner | 22 | The Claude connector |
| 11 | Timeline and Backlog | 23 | Reading & focus: fonts, themes, Focus mode, low-energy days |
| 12 | Bugs / Issues | | |

1 · What Crucible is

Crucible is a personal production tracker for people who build games and 3D assets on their own or in a very small team. It holds your project structure (departments and their pipelines), every piece of work (tasks, assets, stages, bugs), how long things take, what you actually did each day, and it works out what you should do next and whether you will finish on time.

It is built to answer six questions quickly:

- **What am I doing now?** Today's focus on the Dashboard and the Today screen.
- **What should I do next?** The Next step block, computed from your pipelines and dependencies.
- **What is blocking me?** Risks, blockers and conflicts.
- **What department or stage comes next?** Pipeline suggestions when a stage is finished.
- **Am I going to finish on time?** The planner's forecast, capacity and deficit.
- **What changed?** Every item keeps a timestamped history; Reports and the Time log summarise the week.

Everything is rule-based and runs on your machine. There is no AI service behind the suggestions, no network calls and no account. Same project in, same answer out.

2 · Install and first launch

Portable version

- 1 Put **Crucible.exe** (from **Crucible-0.7.0-portable.zip**) anywhere (Desktop, a tools folder, a USB stick).
- 2 Double-click it. The first time, Windows SmartScreen shows "Windows protected your PC" because the file is not code-signed. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. This happens once.
- 3 Crucible opens with a sample project called *Forgotten Temple* so you can see a project mid-flight. Replace it with your own from **Project Settings** → **New project...** (chapter 16).

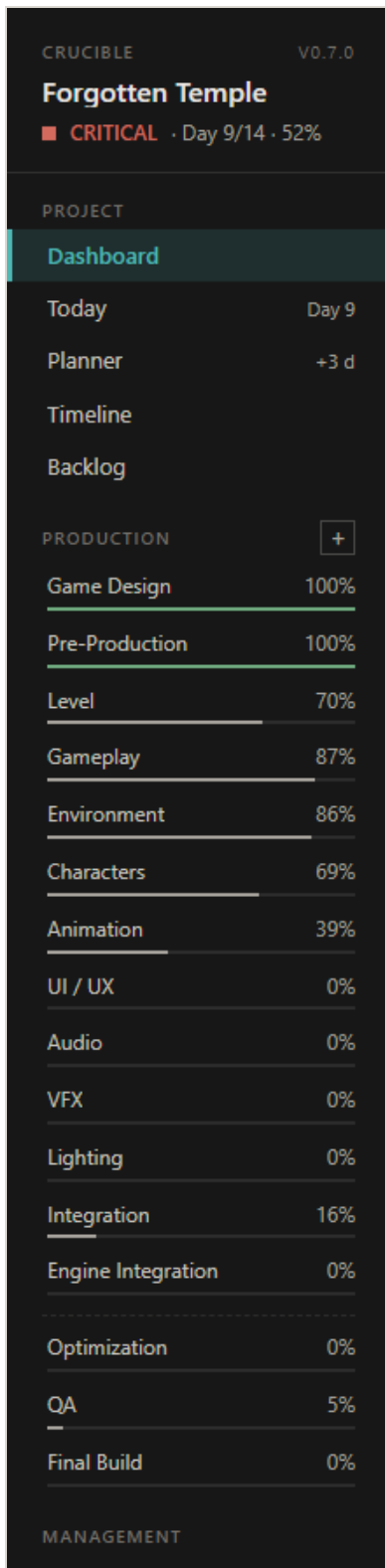
Installer version

If you received **Crucible_0.7.0_x64-setup.exe** instead, run it: it installs for your user only (no admin rights), adds a Start Menu entry and an uninstaller. Both versions store data in the same place, so you can switch between them.

Requirements

- Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit). The app uses the WebView2 runtime that every up-to-date Windows already has.
- About 4 MB of disk space plus your screenshots.
- No internet connection is needed, ever.

3 · The window: rail, header, shortcuts



The rail (left side).

The rail

Top: the project name, its health (ON TRACK / AT RISK / LATE / CRITICAL), the current day and overall progress.

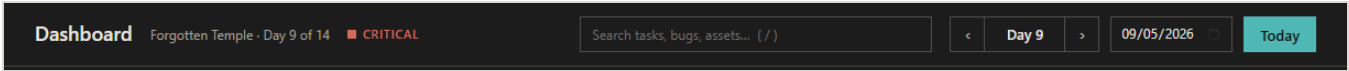
PROJECT: Dashboard, Today, Planner, Timeline, Backlog. The small numbers on the right are live: today's day number, how many days late the forecast is, how many backlog items you have.

PRODUCTION: only the departments *in use*, each with a progress bar. The + opens the department picker (chapter 9). A dashed line separates production departments from finalization ones (Optimization, QA, Final Build...). When a department is finished, a teal "Next:" hint appears here.

MANAGEMENT: Bugs / Issues (with the open-bug count), Search, Time log, Reports.

SETTINGS: Project Settings.

The header



Screen title · project · day · health · search bar · day stepper · calendar date · Today.

- **Search bar:** type anything and Crucible jumps to the Search screen with results (chapter 13). `Esc` clears it.
- **< Day 9 >:** step the current day back or forward. The current day is the day the whole app reasons about ("today").
- **Date field:** jump to a calendar date inside the project.
- **Today:** set the current day from your PC's real date. Turn on "Follow the real calendar" in Settings to do this automatically on launch.

Keyboard shortcuts

KEY	DOES
<code>1</code> <code>2</code> <code>3</code> <code>4</code> <code>5</code> <code>6</code>	Dashboard · Today · Planner · Backlog · Bugs · Time log
<code>/</code>	Search (focuses the search bar)
<code>+</code>	Add department
<code>F</code>	Focus mode on the current item (chapter 23)
<code>C</code>	Capture a thought into the backlog
<code>Esc</code>	Close the item window, Focus mode or any dialog
<code>Enter</code> in "What did you do?"	Save the item
<code>Ctrl</code> + <code>V</code> in the item window	Paste an image from the clipboard as a screenshot

Shortcuts are ignored while you are typing in a field.

4 · The ideas behind it (read this once)

Project, days and capacity

A project has a start date, a duration in days (14 to 365, any number) and a number of working hours per day, on the weekdays you choose. Day 1 is the start date. Duration × hours/day on working days is your **capacity**. Everything else is measured against it.

Departments

A department is a lane of work: Game Design, Modeling, UV, Texturing, Audio, QA... Each has a **weight** (its share of overall project progress; weights in use should add up to 100) and a position in the pipeline order. Departments can be **parked**: hidden and ignored by progress, health and the planner, with all their items kept safe. A catalog of about forty standard departments is built in; you can also create your own.

Work items

One kind of record for everything. An item has a **type** (TASK, ASSET, BUG, DESIGN, MODELING, QA...), a **department**, an optional **parent** (so an asset can have stages under it, and a bug can hang off the stage where you found it), an **estimate** in hours, **logged time**, **progress** and a **remaining** figure, a **status**, a **priority**, an optional **class**, and for bugs a **severity**. Every change is written to the item's **history** with a timestamp; nothing is ever silently overwritten.

FIELD	VALUES	MEANING
Status	BACKLOG · PLANNED · TODO · IN PROGRESS · BLOCKED · DONE · CUT	BACKLOG = known but not on the plan (does not count anywhere). PLANNED/TODO = on a day. DONE requires all <i>required</i> checklist steps and child items to be done.
Priority	MUST HAVE · NICE TO HAVE · CUT	Only MUST HAVE work drives health, overdue and the forecast. CUT is kept but ignored.
Class	S · A · B · C · D	Importance for ordering, independent of priority. S is critical, D is minor. Bugs default to S/A/C/D from their severity.
Severity	CRITICAL · HIGH · MEDIUM · LOW	Bugs only. Critical/high bugs are MUST HAVE and count against project health.
Estimate / Logged / Remaining	hours	Remaining = estimate × (1 – progress), unless you type a remaining figure yourself. Logged is the sum of your time entries.
Progress	0–100 %	Your judgement. DONE forces 100. Parents show the estimate-weighted average of their children.

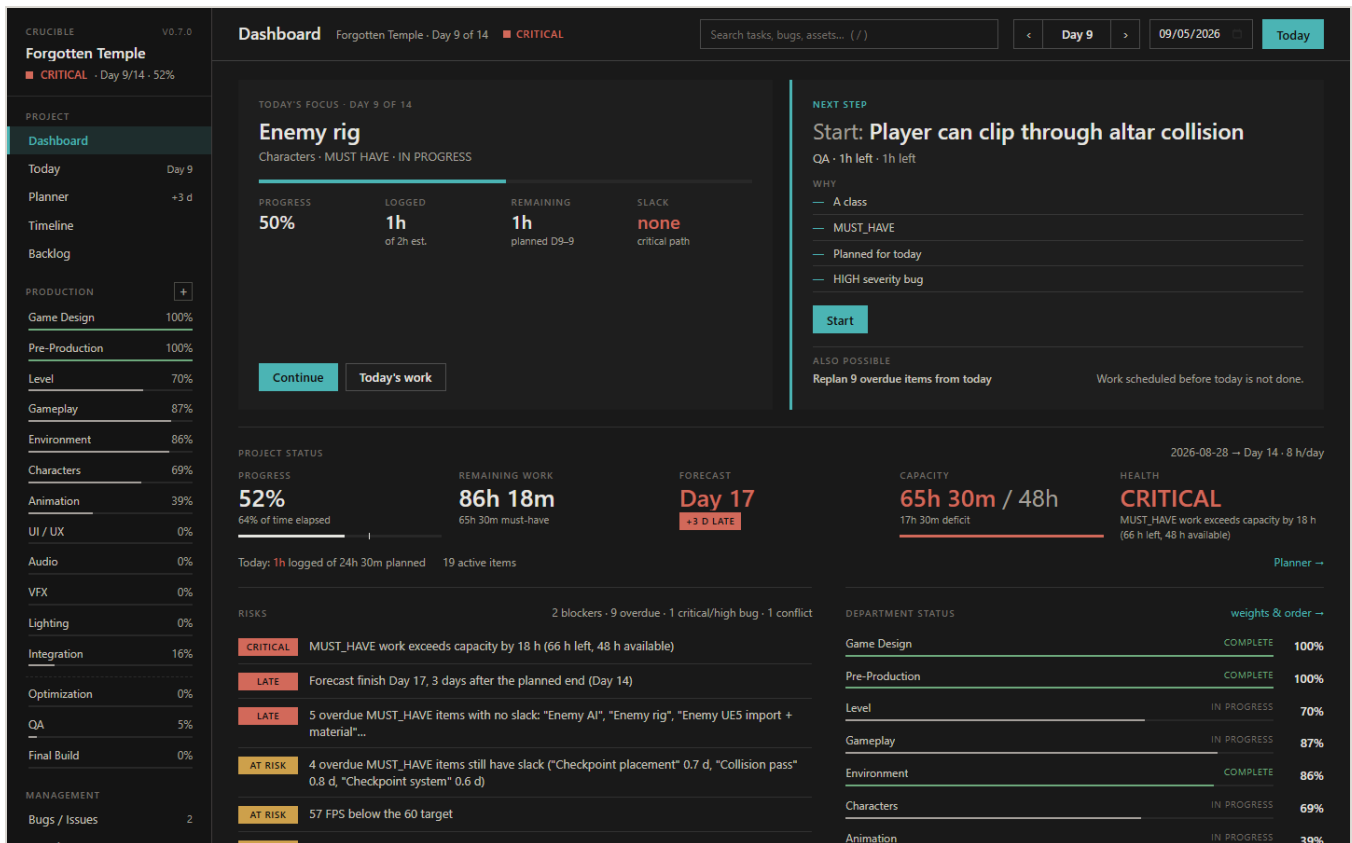
Pipelines, stages and checklists

Each department owns a **pipeline**: an ordered list of stages with default estimates (Reference → Blockout → Modeling → UV → Texturing → ...). When you create an **asset** in a department, the pipeline becomes that asset's child items, chained so each stage depends on the previous one. A stage whose name matches another department in use (UV, Texturing, LOD...) is filed in that department, so department progress follows the asset's checklist. Ticking a stage in a checklist marks the real item DONE.

Planned vs. logged

The planner books hours onto days. When you log time, Crucible compares what was booked with what happened. Estimates that keep running over are flagged as a risk.

5 · Dashboard



Dashboard of the sample project, Day 9 of 14.

The Dashboard is made to be read in ten seconds. Top to bottom:

- **Today's focus:** the item you are working on (in progress, or the best candidate): progress, logged, remaining, slack, and Continue.
- **Next step:** what Crucible recommends, with the reasons, one button to act on it, and alternatives below. Chapter 9 explains where this comes from.
- **Project status:** progress (the small tick on the bar is elapsed time; if the tick is ahead of the bar you are behind), remaining work, the forecast finish day with how many days late or early, capacity used vs. available, and health with its main reason.
- **Risks:** capacity deficit, late forecast, overdue must-have items (with slack vs. no slack), blockers, high bugs, performance below target, planner conflicts. Click one to open the item.
- **Department status:** every department in use with progress and state. Click to open it.
- **Upcoming:** the next production gate (game profiles), the next department the pipeline suggests, the nearest deadline.

6 · Today

CRUCIBLE V0.7.0

Forgotten Temple
■ CRITICAL · Day 9/14 · 52%

PROJECT
Dashboard
Today · Day 9
Planner · +3 d
Timeline
Backlog

PRODUCTION +
Game Design 100%
Pre-Production 100%
Level 70%
Gameplay 87%
Environment 86%
Characters 69%
Animation 39%
UI / UX 0%
Audio 0%
VFX 0%
Lighting 0%
Integration 16%
Optimization 0%
QA 5%
Final Build 0%

MANAGEMENT
Bugs / Issues 2

Today Forgotten Temple · Day 9 of 14 ■ CRITICAL
Search tasks, bugs, assets... (/)

Day 9 · 2026-09-05 UI + audio
Logged 1h / 24h 30m planned Left today 7h Forecast Day 17 Low-energy day Focus

TODAY'S WORK

	CURRENT	MUST HAVE	ESTIMATE	LOGGED	REMAINING	Progress
1	Enemy rig	Characters · IN PROGRESS	2h	1h	1h	50%
2	Player can clip through altar co...	QA · TODO	1h	0m	1h	0%
3	Combat feedback	Gameplay · IN PROGRESS	1h 30m	30m	45m	50%

QUICK ACTIONS · ENEMY RIG + Log time + Comment + Screenshot + Child task + Bug

NEXT STEP
Continue: Enemy rig
Characters · 1h left · 1h left
Continue

ALSO POSSIBLE
Start: Player can clip through altar collision QA · 1h left
Replan 9 overdue items from today Work scheduled before today is not d...

UNFINISHED Replan from today

Enemy rig	— planned to finish Day 8, 50% done	1h left
Enemy UES import + material	— planned to finish Day 8, 0% done	1h 30m left
Character test in level	— planned to finish Day 8, 0% done	1h left
Player combat set	— planned to finish Day 8, 67% done	59m left
Enemy animation	— planned to finish Day 8, 0% done	3h left
Checkpoint placement	— planned to finish Day 5, 0% done	1h left
Collision pass	— planned to finish Day 7, 50% done	1h left
Enemy AI	— planned to finish Day 4, 43% done	2h 17m left
Checkpoint system	— planned to finish Day 5, 0% done	2h left

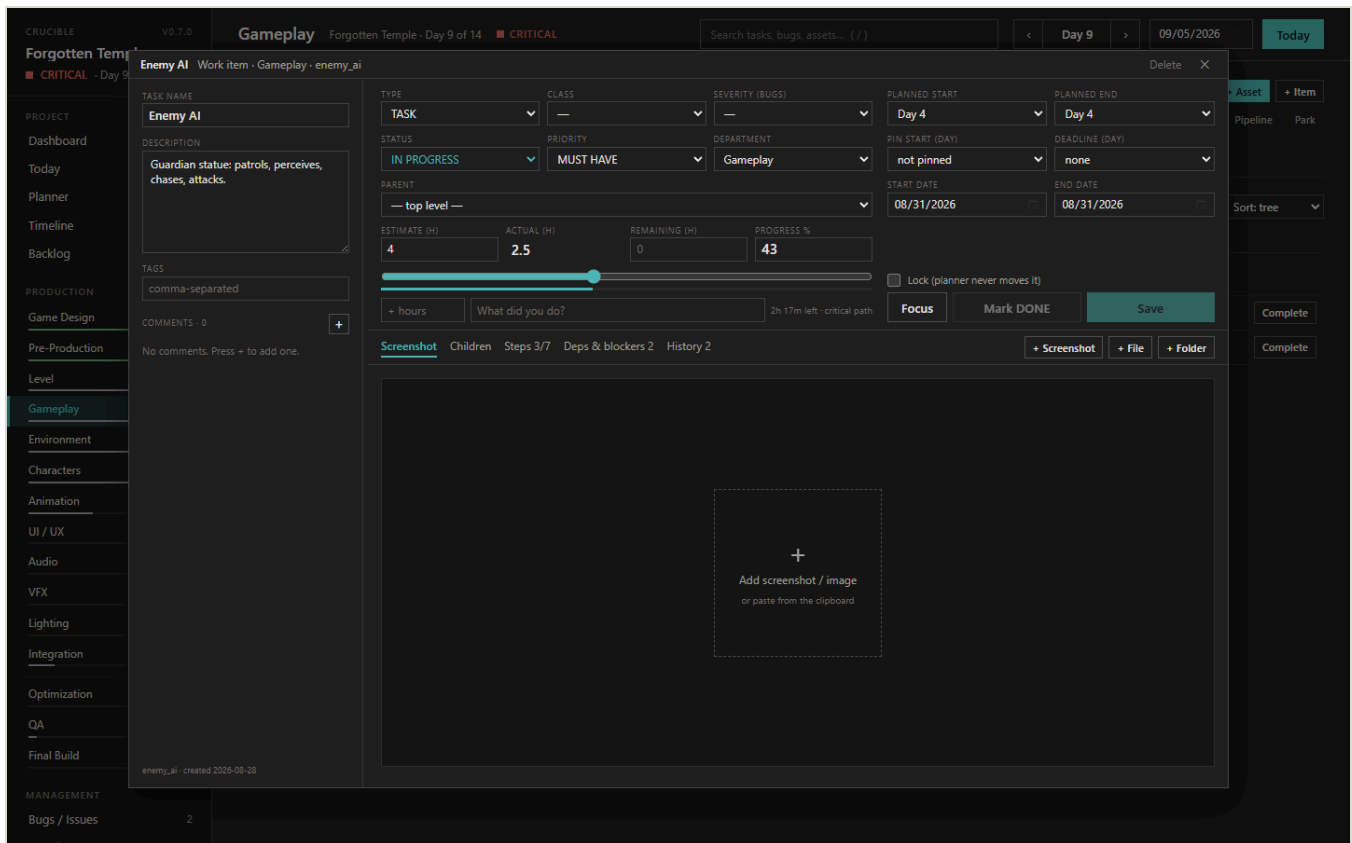
PLANNED TODAY · LOG HOURS & PROGRESS 19 active + Add item

ITEM	CLS	DEPT	PRIORITY	PLAN TODAY	PROGRESS	STATUS	LOG (H · % · NOTE)
------	-----	------	----------	------------	----------	--------	--------------------

Today: current, next and optional work, the next step, unfinished items and the logging table.

- **Today's work:** three rows: Current (the item you are on), Next (best must-have), Optional (best nice-to-have). Each shows estimate, logged, remaining and progress. Click a row to open it.
- **Quick actions** on the current item: + Log time, + Comment, + Screenshot, + Child task, + Bug. The fastest way to record work without opening anything.
- **Next step:** the same recommendation as the Dashboard, compact.
- **Unfinished:** items planned to end yesterday or earlier that are not done, and critical blockers. "Replan from today" re-spreads open work over the remaining days.
- **Planned today · log hours & progress:** every item booked on the current day, with a log row: hours, percent, note, Log. Press **Enter** in the note field to log. Status and priority can be changed inline; "Complete" appears when an item can be finished. Double-click a row to open it.
- **New work discovered:** a capture box. Anything you type goes to the backlog for later scheduling.
- **Low-energy day** (switch at the top right) and the **Focus** button: see chapter 23.

7 · The item window (tasks and bugs)



An item opens in its own window: left column, fields on top, tabs below.

Open an item by **double-clicking its row** anywhere, clicking its title, or from a Next-step button. In the installed app each item opens as a separate window, so you can keep one open beside the main window; changes sync between windows the moment you Save.

Left column

- **Task / bug name** and **Description**.
- For bugs: **Location** (level, engine path, asset) and **Reproduction** steps.
- **Tags**, comma-separated.
- **Comments**: press + to write one. Each comment shows the day and the date-time it was written and when it was last edited.

Fields (top right)

Type, Class, Severity, Status, Priority, Department, Parent, Planned start/end (day and calendar date), Pin start, Deadline, Lock. These apply as soon as you change them.

Time and progress

Estimate, Actual (logged), Remaining, Progress with a slider. Below it, the **+ hours** and **What did you do?** fields log a time entry. The grey text shows what the planner thinks is left and whether the item is on the critical path.

Save model. Name, description, tags, hours, progress, a new comment and new screenshots are *drafts* until you press **Save** (the button shows a dot while something is unsaved). Closing with unsaved changes asks first. Dropdowns and the Lock box apply immediately. **Mark DONE** is enabled only when every required step and child item is finished.

Tabs

- **Screenshot:** the latest screenshot fills the area; thumbnails below switch between them. No screenshot yet? Click the dashed square, or paste an image with **Ctrl + V**. Image files are stored next to your project file; linked files and folders (+ File, + Folder) are only referenced and can be opened or revealed from here.
- **Children:** stages, sub-tasks and bugs under this item, as a checklist. Add a child, add a bug, or apply a pipeline template. "Save as template" turns the current children into a reusable template.
- **Steps:** a lightweight checklist inside the item. Steps marked REQ gate DONE; steps can carry a day.
- **Deps & blockers:** dependencies (must finish first) and blockers with severity. A blocker never changes status by itself; set the item BLOCKED when you cannot continue.
- **History:** the complete thread: created, time, progress, comments, screenshots, status, estimate, schedule, priority, class, severity, department moves. Nothing is deleted from it.

The screenshot displays the 'Bugs / Issues' section of the Crucible interface. The main form is for a bug titled 'Player can clip through altar collision' (Bug - QA - BUG-1). The form includes fields for Bug Name, Description, Type (BUG), Class (A), Severity (HIGH), Status (TODO), Priority (MUST HAVE), Department (QA), Planned Start (Day 9), Planned End (Day 9), Pin Start (not pinned), Deadline (none), Start Date (09/05/2026), and End Date (09/05/2026). It also has a progress bar with Estimate (1h), Actual (0h), Remaining (0h), and Progress % (0%). The 'Reproduction' field contains 'Location: Brazier 3 room'. The 'Tags' field contains 'Brazier 3 room'. The 'Comments' field is empty. The 'Screenshots' tab is active, showing a dashed box for adding a screenshot or image. The interface includes a sidebar with navigation options like Dashboard, Today, Planner, Timeline, Backlog, and various production stages. The top bar shows the project name 'Forgotten Temple' and the current day 'Day 9'.

A bug uses the same window with Location and Reproduction fields and a severity.

8 · Departments

The screenshot displays the 'Gameplay' department for the 'Forgotten Temple' project. The sidebar on the left shows a list of departments with their progress percentages: Game Design (100%), Pre-Production (100%), Level (70%), Gameplay (87%), Environment (86%), Characters (69%), Animation (39%), UI / UX (0%), Audio (0%), VFX (0%), Lighting (0%), Integration (16%), Optimization (0%), QA (5%), and Final Build (0%). The main area shows the department's progress at 87%, with 11 out of 13 must-have items done. The status is 'IN PROGRESS' with 5h 2m remaining. A table of work items is shown below, with columns for item name, class, days, priority, progress, estimate, actual, left, and status. The items listed are 'Enemy AI' (waiting for dependency, blocker, gate, fully playable, overdue), 'Combat feedback' (50% progress), and 'Checkpoint system' (0% progress).

ITEM	CLS	DAYS	PRIORITY	PROGRESS	EST. / ACT. / LEFT	STATUS
Enemy AI Next: Perception - 3/7 steps	---	D4	MUST HAVE	43%	4h / 2h 30m / 2h 17m	IN PROGRESS
Combat feedback	---	D5	NICE TO HAVE	50%	1h 30m / 30m / 45m	IN PROGRESS
Checkpoint system GATE: Fully Playable OVERDUE	---	D5	MUST HAVE	0%	2h / 0m / 2h	TODO

A department: header stats, next step, and the work-item table with filters.

Header

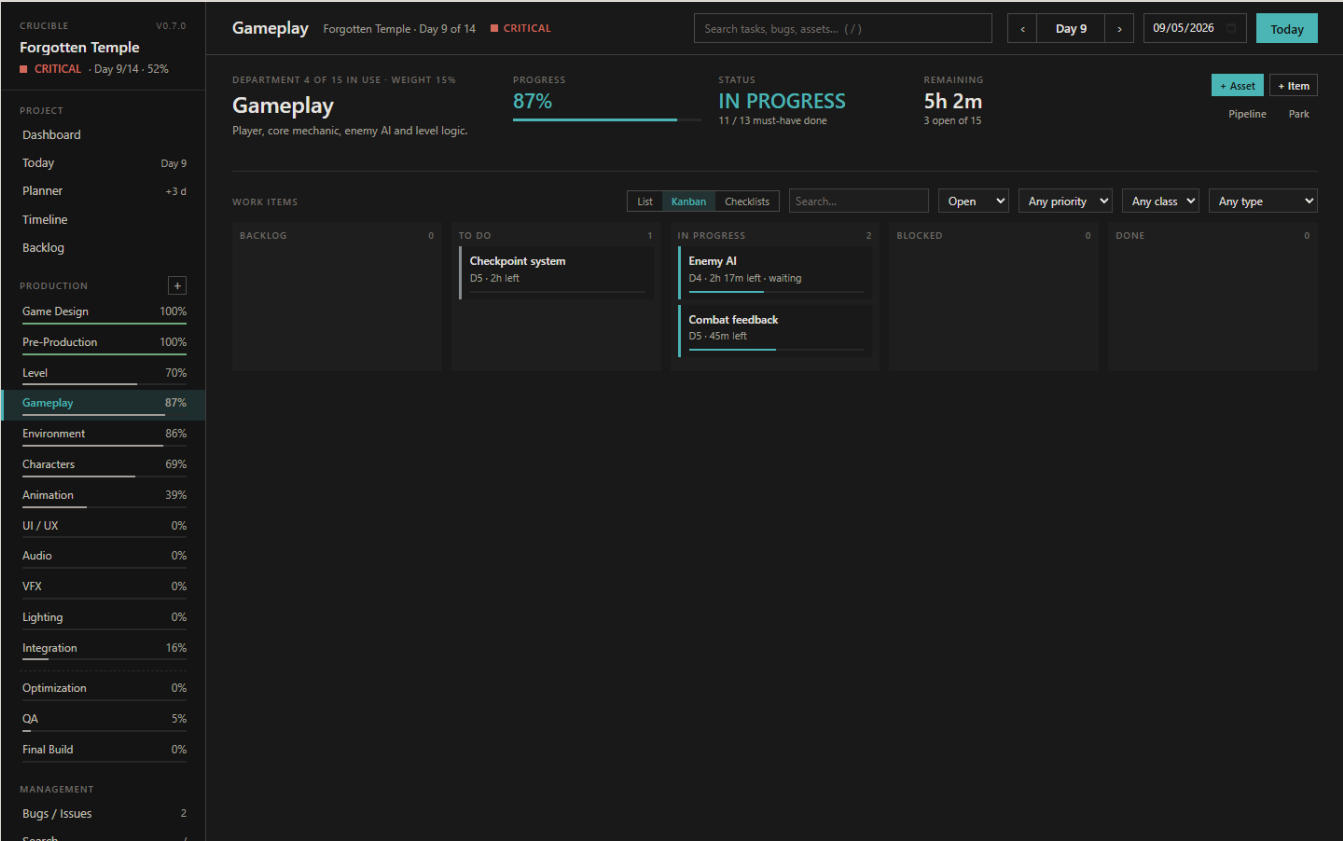
Progress, status (NOT STARTED / IN PROGRESS / BLOCKED / COMPLETE), remaining hours, and the buttons:

- **+ Asset:** creates a parent item and applies the department pipeline as its stages. The normal way to start a prop, a character, a level.
- **+ Item:** a single task planned for today.
- **Pipeline:** opens the pipeline editor (below).
- **Park:** hide the department without deleting anything.

Work items: three views

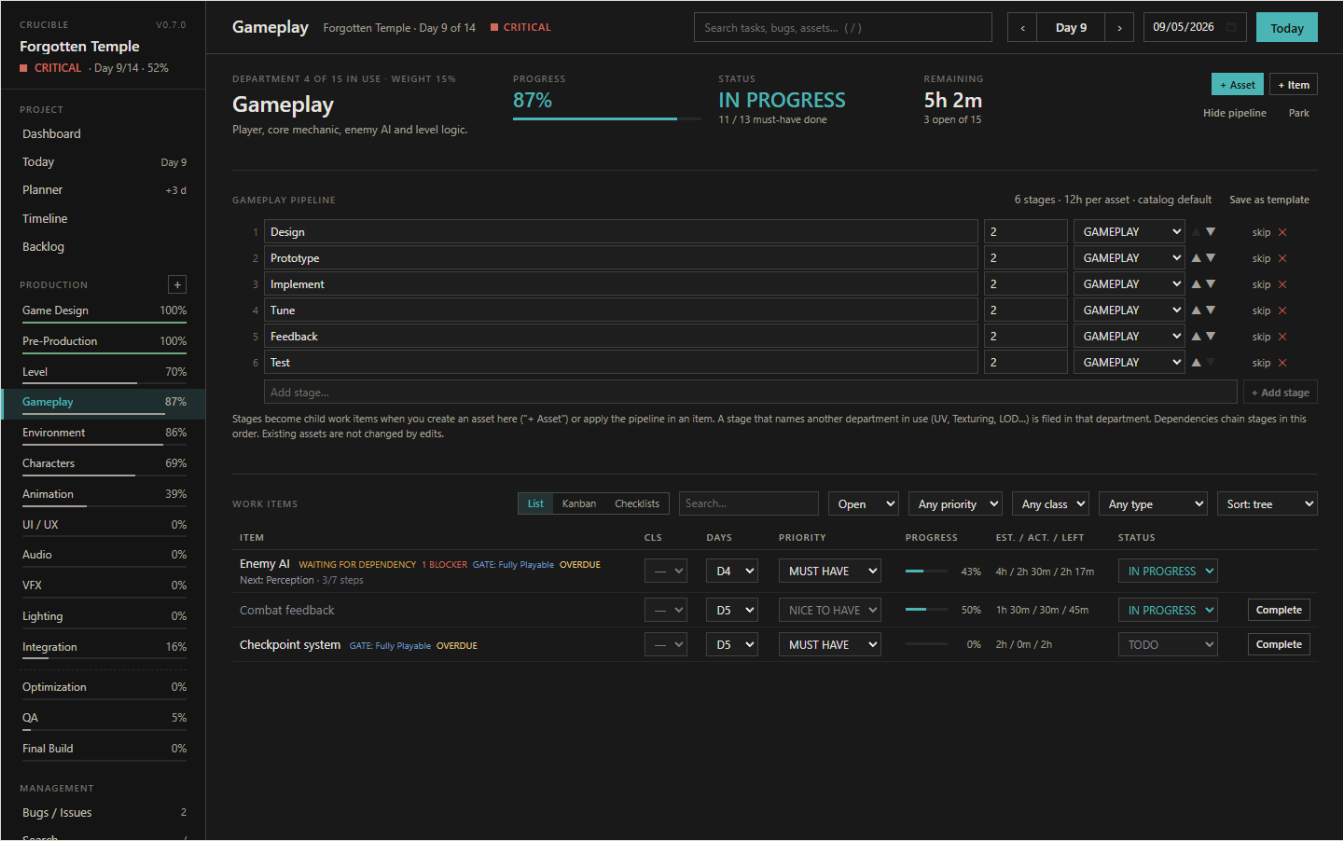
- **List:** a tree: assets with their stages indented. Inline class, day, priority, progress, estimate / actual / left, status. Double-click a row to open it. Sort by tree, day, estimate, progress or newest.
- **Kanban:** Backlog · To do · In progress · Blocked · Done. Drag a card to change its status (dragging from Backlog to To do schedules it for today).
- **Checklists:** one card per asset with its stages as tick boxes. Ticking completes the real stage item; the current stage is highlighted.

Filters: search, Open / All / Backlog / Done / Bugs, priority, class, type.



Kanban view of the same department.

Pipeline editor



Each department's pipeline: rename, re-estimate, reorder, skip, remove, add stages; reset to the catalog default; save as a template.

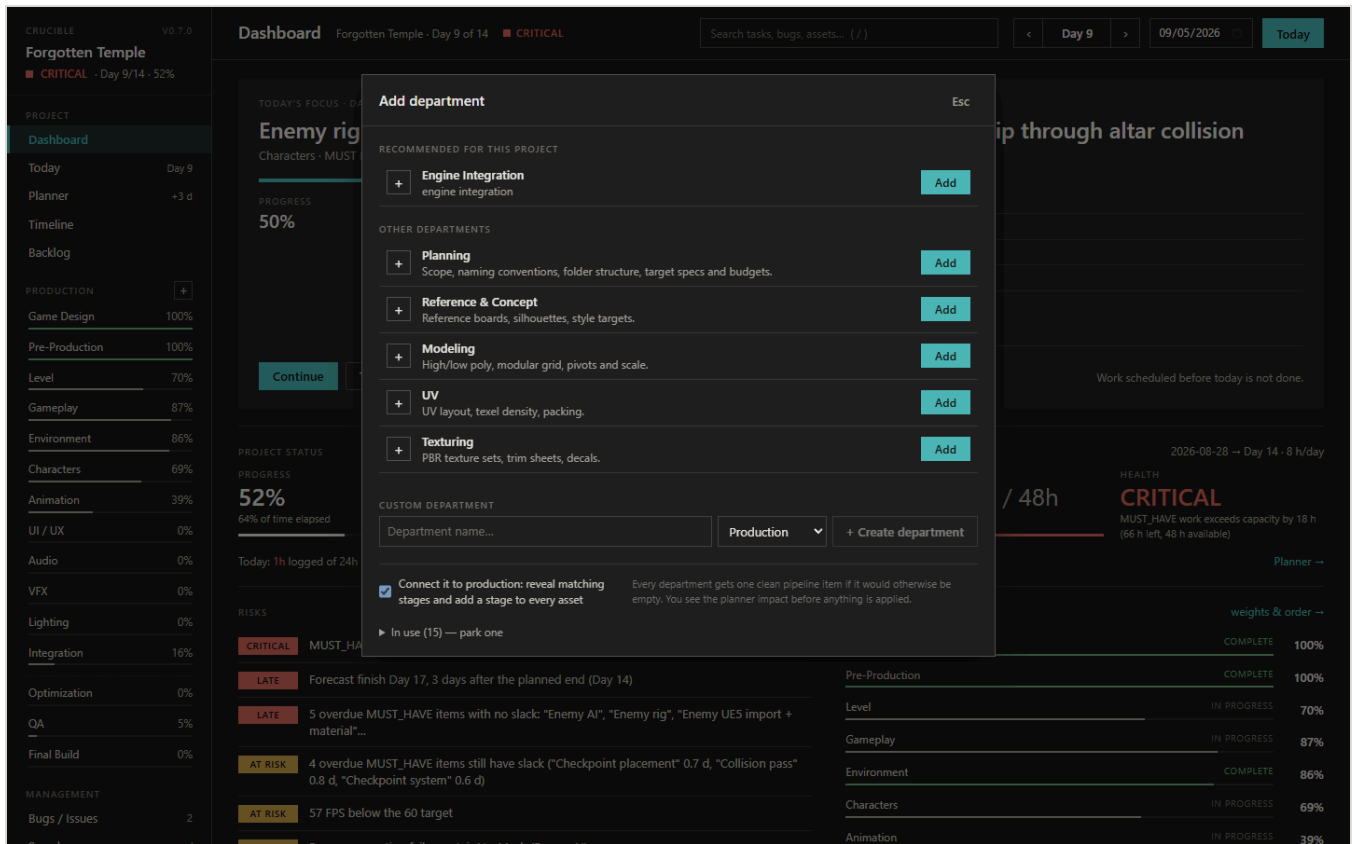
Edits apply to assets you create from now on; existing assets keep their stages. A skipped stage stays in the list but is not applied. "Save as template" makes the pipeline available in every item's "Apply pipeline template" list.

Special panels

Game-profile projects get extra panels: **Integration** shows "fully playable", **Optimization** has the performance fields (current FPS, CPU/GPU ms, memory) against the target, **Final Build** shows the six production gates.

9 · Adding a department and the next-step engine

The department picker



PRODUCTION + opens the picker.

- **Recommended for this project:** departments the project description suggests, plus the next stage of the pipeline when a department is complete (marked "next stage").
- **Other departments:** the rest of the catalog. Parked departments appear here too and say so.
- **Custom department:** your own name, in Production or Finalization.
- **Connect it to production** (ticked by default): when the new department joins, existing stages that carry its name are filed into it, every asset that has no such stage gets one (depending on the asset's last stage), and those stages are put on the plan from today. Untick to add an empty department.
- **In use — park one:** park a department from here.

Nothing is added silently: you press Add. Then the impact appears.

The impact banner

The screenshot shows the Crucible dashboard for 'Forgotten Temple' on Day 9 of 14. The dashboard is divided into several sections:

- Left Sidebar:** Contains navigation links for Dashboard, Today, Planner, Timeline, Backlog, and a list of production tasks with their completion percentages (e.g., Game Design 100%, Pre-Production 100%, Level 70%, etc.).
- Top Header:** Includes the project name 'Forgotten Temple', a search bar, and navigation controls for the current day (Day 9) and date (09/05/2026).
- Impact Banner:** A prominent section at the top right of the main content area. It displays the following information:
 - ENGINE INTEGRATION DEPARTMENT ADDED:** REVIEW BEFORE APPLYING
 - NEW WORK:** none (1 item created, 0 stages put on the plan)
 - PLANNER IMPACT:** no change
 - FORECAST:** Day 17 → Day 17 (project ends Day 14)
 - CRITICAL PATH:** Unchanged (4 items with no slack)
 - CAPACITY:** 38h 18m deficitButtons for 'Review plan' and 'Open Engine Integration' are present.
- Today's Focus:** A section titled 'Enemy rig' (Characters - MUST HAVE - IN PROGRESS) showing progress (50%), logged time (1h), remaining time (1h), and slack (none). It includes 'Continue' and 'Today's work' buttons.
- Next Step:** A section titled 'Start: Player can clip through altar collision' (QA - 1h left - 1h left) with a 'Start' button and a list of reasons why it's the next step (A class, MUST_HAVE, Planned for today, HIGH severity bug).
- Project Status:** A summary section at the bottom showing overall progress (52%), remaining work (86h 18m), forecast (Day 17, +3 D LATE), capacity (65h 30m / 48h, 17h 30m deficit), and health (CRITICAL).

After adding a department: new work, planner impact, forecast before → after, critical path, capacity.

The numbers are a preview: existing items only move when you apply a plan in the Planner. "Review plan" takes you there.

How the next step is chosen

Deterministic rules, in this order. The first one that applies is *the* next step; the rest are listed as alternatives.

1. **Resolve a critical blocker** on must-have or critical-path work.
2. **Continue** an item already in progress.
3. **Start / schedule the next stage** of an asset whose previous stage is done ("Modeling is complete").
4. **Start** the highest-ranked actionable item (class, priority, critical path, gate need, overdue, deadline, severity all score).
5. **Start a department** that follows a completed one in the pipeline and is in use but not started.
6. **Add a department** that follows a completed one but is not in use yet. You can **Ignore** these; ignored suggestions can be restored in Settings.
7. **Replan** when must-have work is overdue.
8. **Capture work** when there is nothing to do.

10 · Planner

The screenshot shows the 'Planner' interface in Crucible 0.7.0. The interface is divided into several sections:

- Duration & Capacity:** Shows a 14-day duration from 2026-08-28 to 2026-09-10. It displays capacity left (48h), remaining work (86h 17m), deficit (38h 18m), and forecast (Day 17). A 'Capacity deficit: 38h 18m' section offers recovery options: 'Extend to Day 17', 'Raise hours/day', and 'Reduce scope (20h 48m NICE_TO_HAVE)'.
- Auto-Schedule:** Shows a preview of the schedule with a bar chart indicating capacity usage. It includes options to 'Open items from today (keep DONE & locked)' or 'Everything from Day 1', and a 'Write day objectives' checkbox.
- Conflicts:** Lists items that the planner cannot resolve for you, such as 'Capacity deficit: 38 h'.
- Advisor:** Provides rule-based suggestions, such as 'Open MUST_HAVE work (66 h) does not fit in 6 days at 8 h/day' and '9 MUST_HAVE tasks are scheduled before today and not done'.
- Critical Path & Slack:** Lists tasks like 'Enemy rig', 'Enemy animation', 'Enemy UE5 import + material', and 'Enemy AI' with their respective durations and slack times.

Planner: duration, capacity, auto-schedule preview, conflicts, critical path, advisor, departments.

Duration & capacity

Presets 14 · 21 · 30 · 45 · 60 · 90 · 180 · 365 or a custom length. Shortening never deletes work: items past the new end are pulled back to the last day and listed first so you can confirm. Capacity left, remaining work, deficit and forecast are shown; a deficit opens the recovery options: extend, raise hours/day, reduce nice-to-have work. You choose.

Auto-schedule

The planner takes every open item (not backlog, not parked, not cut), sorts it by critical path → class → priority → gate need → deadline → department order → slack, keeps dependencies in order, then fills the days: pinned items on their day, everything else forward from today, spilling multi-hour items across days by real capacity. Locked and DONE items never move. The preview shows items placed, hours, the critical path, conflicts and a bar per day (amber = over capacity). **APPLY PLAN** writes the days onto the items and records a schedule entry in each history. "Write day objectives" fills the Timeline objectives from the departments worked each day.

Conflicts

Things the planner refuses to hide: capacity deficit, a missed deadline, a pin on an overloaded or non-working day, a pin before its dependency, a dependency loop, work that could not be placed. Each names the item and the reason.

Critical path & slack

Zero-slack items are listed in order; any delay on them moves the end date. Items with little slack are named below.

Advisor

Plain-language checks with one-click fixes: weights not summing to 100, parked departments with open work, keyword-based department suggestions from your description, missing estimates, extend/shorten the duration to fit the work, overdue → replan, an overloaded day, blank objectives.

Departments table

In use, order (▲▼), name, weight, group, description, item count. Normalize weights to 100, load a preset, add from the catalog, or remove a department (its items move to a neighbour; parking is safer).

11 · Timeline and Backlog



Timeline: one card per day with its objective, must-have progress and items; weeks for long projects.

Each day card has an editable objective, the must-have completion bar, the items ending that day with a day selector to move them, and any dated checklist steps. "+ Add task" creates an item on that day.

CRUCIBLE

VO.7.0

Forgotten Temple

■ CRITICAL · Day 9/14 · 52%

PROJECT

Dashboard

Today Day 9

Planner +3 d

Timeline

Backlog

PRODUCTION

Game Design 100%

Pre-Production 100%

Level 70%

Gameplay 87%

Environment 86%

Characters 69%

Animation 39%

UI / UX 0%

Audio 0%

VFX 0%

Lighting 0%

Integration 16%

Optimization 0%

QA 5%

Final Build 0%

MANAGEMENT

Bugs / Issues 2

Search /

Backlog

Forgotten Temple · Day 9 of 14 ■ CRITICAL

Search tasks, bugs, assets... (/)

< Day 9 >

09/05/2026

Today

BACKLOG

0 items · 0m (0m MUST_HAVE) · not counted in progress or the schedule until you give them a day.

CAPTURE

What needs doing?

TASK

Class —

MUST HAVE

Gameplay

2

Capture

UNSCHEDULED WORK

sort by class priority department estimate created

ITEM	CLS	DEPT	PRIORITY	EST.	SCHEDULE ON
Backlog is empty.					

Backlog: unscheduled work.

Capture known work fast (title, type, class, priority, department, estimate) without giving it a day. Backlog items are not counted in progress, health or the forecast until you schedule them with "Schedule on" or the planner. Sort by class, priority, department, estimate or created.

12 · Bugs / Issues

CRUCIBLE

VO.7.0

Forgotten Temple

CRITICAL · Day 9/14 · 52%

PROJECT

Dashboard

Today

Day 9

Planner

+3 d

Timeline

Backlog

PRODUCTION

+

Game Design

100%

Pre-Production

100%

Level

70%

Gameplay

87%

Environment

86%

Characters

69%

Animation

39%

UI / UX

0%

Audio

0%

VFX

0%

Lighting

0%

Integration

16%

Optimization

0%

QA

5%

Final Build

0%

MANAGEMENT

Bugs / Issues

2

Bugs / Issues

Forgotten Temple · Day 9 of 14

CRITICAL

Search tasks, bugs, assets... (/)

<

Day 9

>

09/05/2026

Today

OPEN

2

1 closed

CRITICAL

0

HIGH

1

MEDIUM

1

LOW

0

OPEN WORK

2h

not affecting health

LOG A BUG

What is wrong?

MEDIUM

No related item

Gameplay

Log bug

Reproduction notes (optional)

Critical / high bugs are MUST_HAVE and count against project health; medium / low are NICE_TO_HAVE. Paste screenshots in the bug's thread.

BUGS

2 results · 2h left

Search title, description, location, tags, id... (press / anywhere)

Open

Any priority

Any department

Any class

Any severity

Day

from

to

Created

mm/dd/yyyy

mm/dd/yyyy

leaves only

Sort: relevance

ITEM

TYPE

DEPARTMENT

PARENT

CLS

PRIORITY

SEVERITY

DAYS

PROGRESS

EST. / LEFT

STATUS

CREATED

A

BUG

Player can dip through altar collision

BRAZIER 3 ROOM

BUG

QA

—

A

MUST HAVE

HIGH

D9

0%

1h / 1h

TODO

2026-08-28

C

BUG

Brazier light pops on reload

CHECKPOINT RELOAD

BUG

QA

—

C

NICE TO HAVE

MEDIUM

D9

0%

1h / 1h

TODO

2026-08-28

Day 9 is 2026-09-05. Results stay in their departments; open one to edit it.

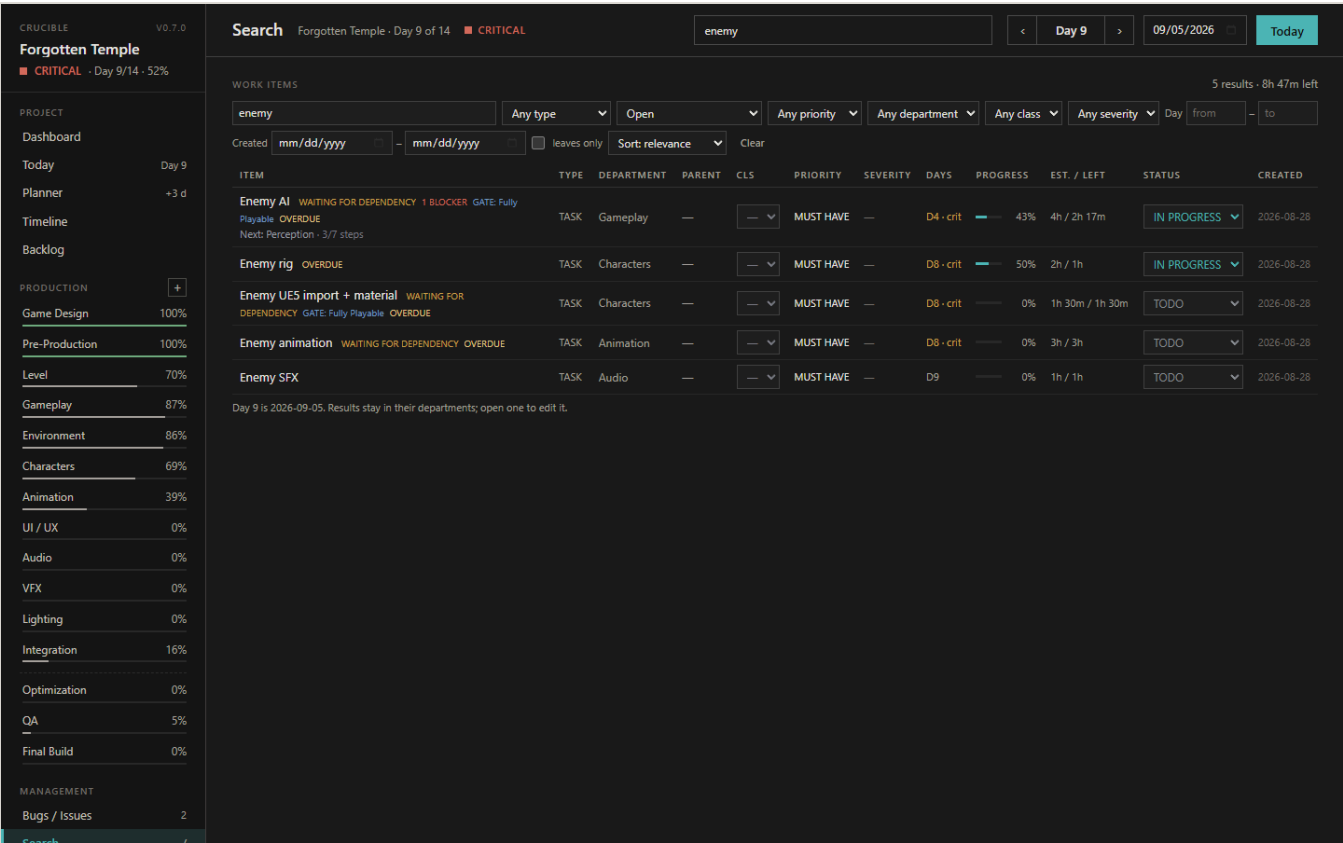
Bugs from every department in one place.

A bug is an ordinary work item with type BUG. It can live at the top level or under the asset or stage where you found it (then "Related to" shows the parent). The counters at the top show open bugs by severity and their remaining hours, and whether they currently affect project health.

Log a bug: title, severity, related item (optional), department, reproduction notes. Critical and high bugs become MUST HAVE and are planned for today; medium and low are NICE TO HAVE. Screenshots go in the bug's window.

The table below is the search component (chapter 13) locked to bugs. Double-click a row to open the bug window.

13 · Search

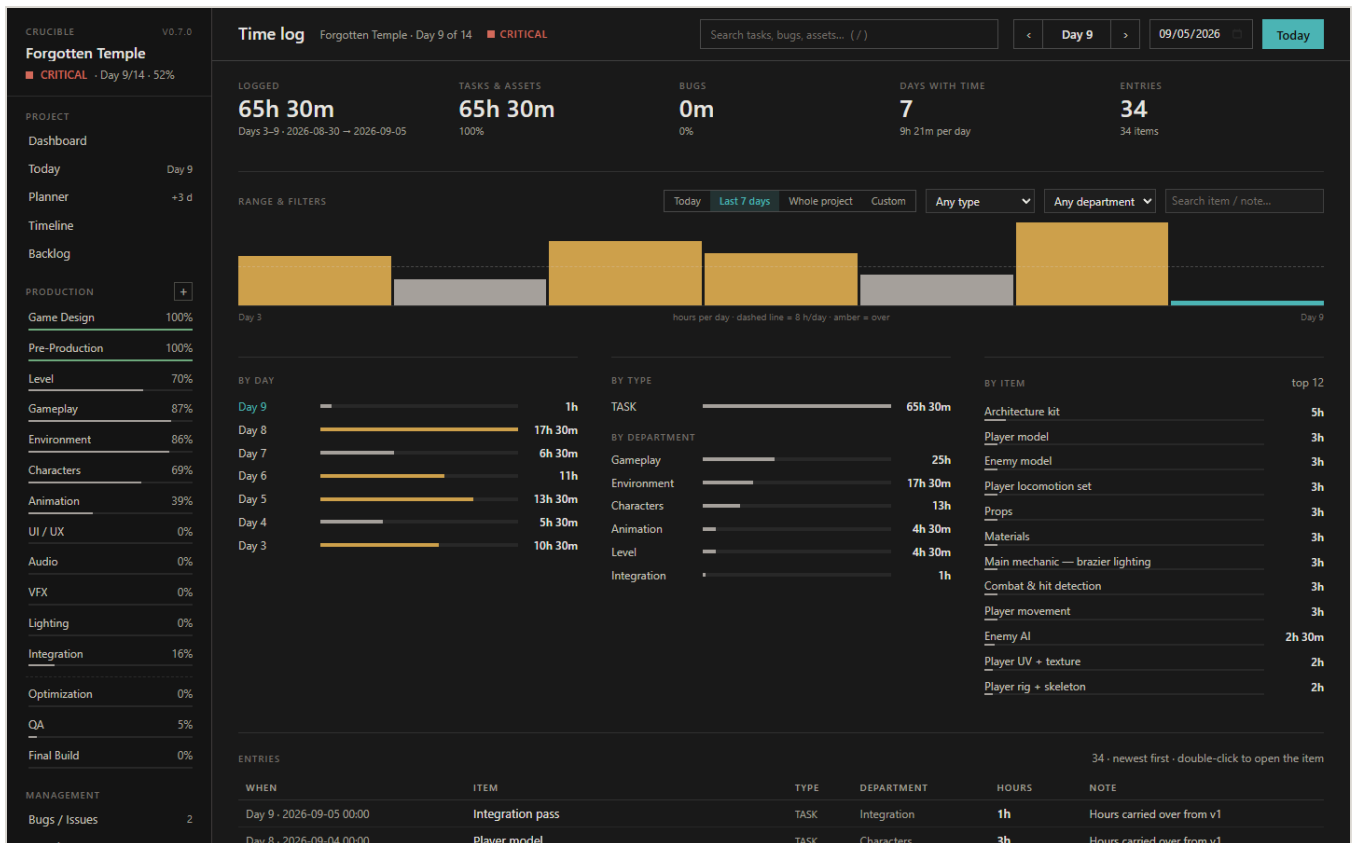


Search across every department with filters.

Type in the header search bar from any screen, or press . Matches on title (ranked first), the parent's title, description, location, reproduction notes, tags, id and department name. Several words must all match.

Filters: type · plan state (Open, All, Unscheduled, Planned, Planned today, Overdue, In progress, Blocked, Done) · priority · department · class · severity · planned day from–to · created date from–to · leaves only (hide parents) · sort (relevance, newest, oldest, planned day, estimate, remaining, progress, severity, class). Filters are remembered per screen. The line on the right counts results and remaining hours.

14 · Time log



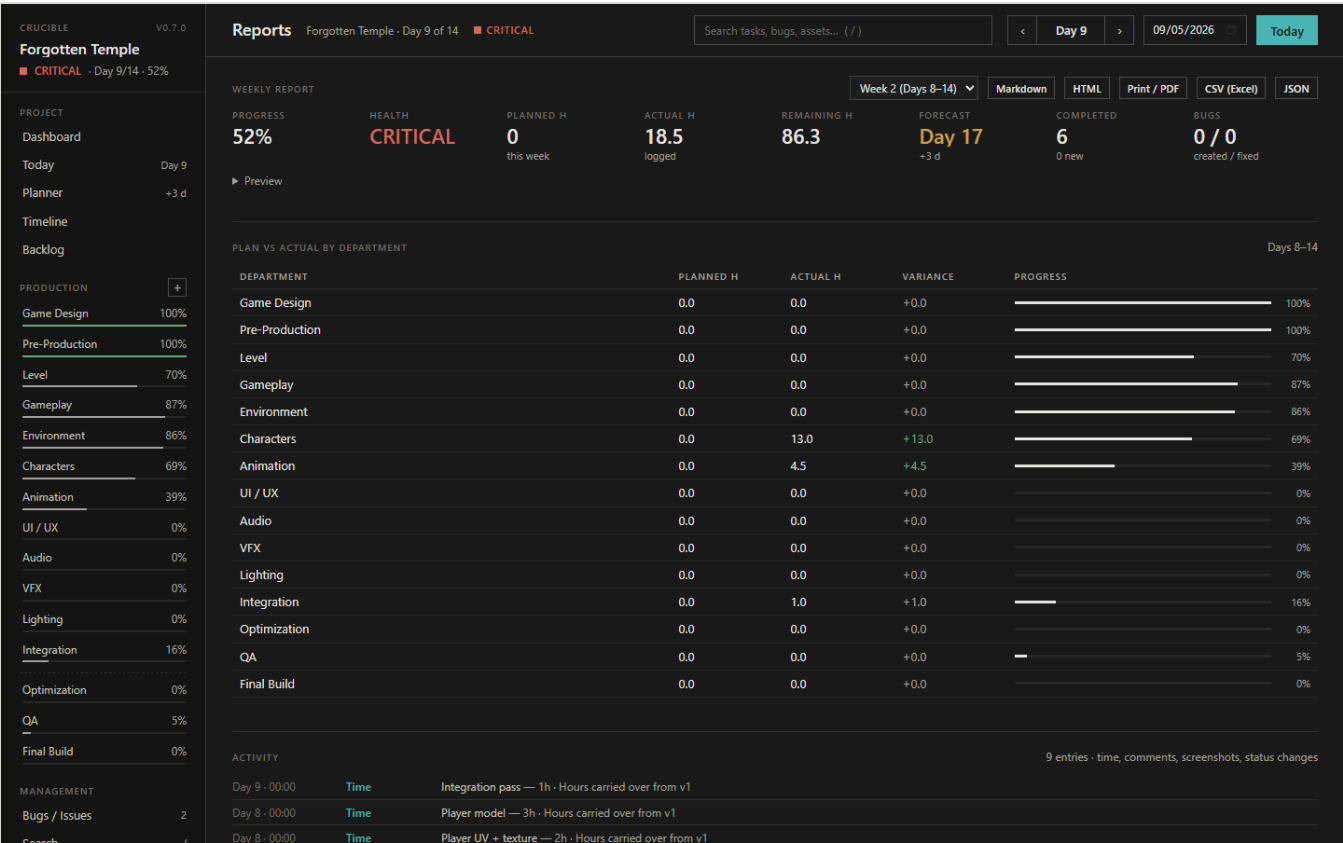
Everything you logged: by day, by type, by department, by item, and every entry.

Every "+ hours" you log, from Today or an item window, becomes a time entry with a day, a timestamp and a note. The Time log screen adds them up so you can see where your hours actually went.

- **Totals:** logged hours in the range, split into tasks & assets vs. bugs, the number of days with time (and the average per day), and the number of entries.
- **Range:** Today, Last 7 days, Whole project, or a custom day range. Filter by type and department, or search the item name and note.
- **Chart:** hours per day; the dashed line is your hours/day setting, amber bars went over it, the teal bar is today.
- **By day · By type · By department · By item:** ranked breakdowns. Click an item to open it.
- **Entries:** the full list, newest first, with the note you wrote. Double-click a row to open the item. Negative entries are corrections.

Time is never edited in place. To correct a mistake, log a negative amount on the same item (for example -1) with a note; both entries stay in the history.

15 · Reports



Weekly report with exports, plan vs actual by department, and the activity stream.

- **Weekly report:** pick a week: progress, health, planned vs actual hours, remaining, forecast, completed, new, bugs created / fixed, blockers, departments, critical path, major changes, risks and recommendations. Export as **Markdown**, **HTML**, **Print / PDF**, **CSV** (all items, for Excel) or **JSON**.
- **Plan vs actual by department:** booked hours against logged hours for the week, with variance and progress.
- **Activity:** every time entry, comment, screenshot, status change and creation in the week, newest first.

16 · Project Settings and the New Project wizard

CRUCIBLE V0.7.0

Forgotten Temple
■ CRITICAL · Day 9/14 · 52%

PROJECT

Dashboard
Today Day 9
Planner +3 d
Timeline
Backlog

PRODUCTION +

Game Design 100%
Pre-Production 100%
Level 70%
Gameplay 87%
Environment 86%
Characters 69%
Animation 39%
UI / UX 0%
Audio 0%
VFX 0%
Lighting 0%
Integration 16%
Optimization 0%
QA 5%
Final Build 0%

MANAGEMENT

Bugs / Issues 2

Project Settings Forgotten Temple · Day 9 of 14 ■ CRITICAL

Search tasks, bugs, assets... (/)

< Day 9 > 09/05/2026 Today

PROJECT New project...

PROJECT NAME
Forgotten Temple

DESCRIPTION (DRIVES DEPARTMENT RECOMMENDATIONS)
One sunken-temple level: relight four braziers, survive the guardian, escape.

TYPE Game, Level, Asset pack... **PROFILE** Game **ENGINE** Unreal Engine 5

TARGET PLATFORM PC (Windows, DX12) **TARGET FPS** 60

DURATION & CAPACITY

START DATE 08/28/2026 **DURATION (DAYS)** 14 **Apply** **HOURS PER DAY** 8

Ends 2026-09-10. Presets (14 ... 365) and auto-scheduling live in the Planner. Nothing is deleted when you shorten.

WORKING DAYS
☒ Sun ☒ Mon ☒ Tue ☒ Wed ☒ Thu ☒ Fri ☒ Sat Capacity = working days × hours/day.

CURRENT DAY Day 9 **CURRENT DATE (CALENDAR)** 09/05/2026

☐ Follow the real calendar (current day updates from today's date on load)

PROJECTS 1 stored

NAME	ITEMS	DAY	UPDATED
Forgotten Temple open	114	9/14	—

"New project..." above adds a project; the current one is kept. Switch from the sidebar or here. Each project has its own folder and screenshots.

Project Settings.

- **Project:** name, description (it drives department recommendations), type, profile (Game, Asset library, Level, Minimal, Custom), engine, platform, target FPS.
- **Duration & capacity:** start date, duration, hours per day, working days, current day, calendar date, "Follow the real calendar".
- **Projects:** every project stored on this PC — Open, Delete (moved to a trash folder, never destroyed). See chapter 21.
- **Data:** Export JSON, Import JSON, Reset to defaults (blank 30-day project with the standard departments and one clean pipeline item each), Reset to sample project, Add template to each department, Restore ignored suggestions. The line below shows where the open project is saved.
- **Claude connector:** the two setup snippets for Claude Code and the Claude desktop app. See chapter 22.

New project wizard

The screenshot displays the 'New project wizard' in the Crucible application. The interface is divided into several sections:

- Left Sidebar:** Contains navigation links for 'Dashboard', 'Today', 'Planner', 'Timeline', 'Backlog', and 'PRODUCTION' (with a sub-menu for 'Game Design', 'Pre-Production', 'Level', 'Gameplay', 'Environment', 'Characters', 'Animation', 'UI / UX', 'Audio', 'VFX', 'Lighting', 'Integration', 'Optimization', 'QA', 'Final Build').
- Top Header:** Shows the project name 'Forgotten Temple', its status 'CRITICAL', and progress 'Day 9/14 · 52%'. It also includes a search bar and navigation buttons for 'Day 9' and '09/05/2026'.
- Main Content Area:**
 - Today's Work:** A table listing tasks for 'Day 9 · 2026-09-05'. Tasks include 'Enemy rig' (50% progress), 'Player can clip through altar co...' (0% progress), and 'Combat feedback' (50% progress).
 - Next Step:** A section titled 'Continue: Enemy rig' with a 'Continue' button.
 - Also Possible:** A section titled 'Start: Player can clip through altar collision' with a 'Replan 9 overdue items from today' button.
 - Unfinished:** A list of tasks that are not yet completed, such as 'Enemy rig', 'Enemy UES import + material', 'Character test in level', etc.
 - Planned Today:** A table with columns for 'ITEM', 'CLS', 'DEPT', 'PRIORITY', 'PLAN TODAY', 'PROGRESS', 'STATUS', and 'LOG (H - % - NOTE)'.

Five steps; nothing is created until the last one.

1. **Basic info:** name, description, type, profile, engine, platform, start date, hours/day, duration (presets or custom), working days.
2. **Production structure:** the departments recommended from your description, each with the reason. Untick what you don't need; add optional ones.
3. **Pipeline templates:** each department's pipeline, editable; choose which departments get a starter item; optionally list your first assets (one per line) and they are created with the Environment or Modeling pipeline.
4. **Planner:** estimated work, capacity, conflicts, critical path and forecast for the project as it would be created.
5. **Review:** summary, then **Create project**. The new project is added next to the current one and opened. Tick "Replace the current project instead" if you really want to overwrite it (export first).

17 · A normal working day

- 1 Open Crucible. Press **Today** in the header if the day is not right (or let it follow the calendar).
- 2 Read the Dashboard: focus, next step, health. Ten seconds.
- 3 Go to **Today** and start on the Current row. Work.
- 4 When you stop, record it: hours and a one-line note in the log row (or in the item window: + hours, What did you do?, a screenshot of the result, **Save**). Adjust the progress slider honestly.
- 5 Found a problem? + **Bug** on Today, or "Create bug" from the item. It lands under the item you were on.
- 6 Finished a stage? Tick it in the checklist or Mark DONE. The next stage becomes the next step; if it belongs to a department you have not added yet, the picker offers it with the plan impact.
- 7 Something slipped? "Replan from today" on Today or the Dashboard, or APPLY PLAN in the Planner. Read the forecast. If it is red, choose a recovery option; Crucible never cuts work for you.
- 8 End of the day: check the Time log to see where the hours went. End of the week: Reports → export or print the weekly report.

18 · Your data: where it lives, backups, sharing

- Each project is one file, **project.json**, in its own folder: **%APPDATA%\dev.armaan.crucible\projects\
<id>**. Its screenshots are in an **attachments** folder inside that project folder. Linked files and folders stay where they are; only their paths are kept.
- Crucible saves automatically a quarter of a second after every change and keeps the previous version as **project.json.bak**.
- **Backup:** Settings → Export JSON writes a copy anywhere you like. Do this before Reset or Import.
- **Move to another PC:** export, copy the JSON (and the attachments folder if you want the screenshots), import there.
- **Old files:** projects from earlier Crucible versions open fine; they are upgraded in place and nothing is dropped. Upgrading from 0.4 moves your single project into the new **projects** folder on first launch; old screenshots stay where they were and keep working.
- **Deleted projects** go to **projects_trash**; copy the folder back out to restore one.
- No data ever leaves your computer.

19 · Questions and answers

WHY IS MY DEPARTMENT AT 0 % WHEN I HAVE DONE WORK?

Only items on the plan count. Backlog items (including the "— template" items) are ignored until they get a day. Also check the department is not parked.

MARK DONE IS GREYED OUT.

The item still has required steps (Steps tab, marked REQ) or open child items. Finish or cut them, or untick REQ on a step you do not need.

REMAINING HOURS LOOK WRONG AFTER I LOGGED TIME.

Remaining is derived from progress, not from logged time. Move the progress slider, or type a remaining figure directly.

THE FORECAST IS LATER THAN THE PROJECT END.

That is the planner being honest: open must-have work does not fit the remaining capacity. Extend the duration, raise hours per day, defer nice-to-have work, or accept the risk.

I ADDED A DEPARTMENT BUT THE ITEMS DID NOT MOVE.

The impact banner is a preview. Go to the Planner and APPLY PLAN to write new days onto the items.

A SUGGESTION KEEPS COMING BACK.

Press Ignore on it. Ignored suggestions can be restored in Settings → Data.

WHERE DID MY "OPEN" BUTTON GO?

Double-click any row, or click the title.

CAN TWO PEOPLE USE IT?

Not at the same time. Share the JSON export; team fields exist in the data for a future version.

20 · Feature checklist

AREA	FEATURES
Project	Name, description, type, profile, engine, platform, target FPS · start date · duration 1–365 days with presets · hours/day · working days · current day and calendar date · follow real calendar
Departments	Catalog of ~40 · presets (game, asset library, minimal) · custom departments · weights and normalize to 100 · order · production / finalization groups · park / un-park · remove with item move · recommendation from description · next-stage suggestion
Pipelines	Per-department editable stages (add, rename, estimate, type, reorder, skip, remove, reset) · save as template · apply as asset checklist · stages filed into matching departments · reveal / extend / schedule stages when a department is added
Work items	Types task / asset / bug / design / modeling / gameplay / improvement / polish / QA / future · parent-child hierarchy with rollups · status, priority, class, severity · estimate, logged, remaining, progress · planned start/end, pin, deadline, lock · dependencies · blockers · tags · checklist steps with day and required flag · location and reproduction for bugs · comments with edit history · screenshots (file or paste) · linked files and folders (open / reveal) · full timestamped history · delete with children
Item window	Separate window per item (installed app) · draft-then-Save · Mark DONE with gate · Screenshot / Children / Steps / Deps & blockers / History tabs · apply pipeline template · save children as template
Planning	Deterministic scheduler with real capacity · critical path and slack · dependencies · pins, locks, deadlines honoured · conflicts explained · open-from-today or everything-from-day-1 · frozen per-day bookings · day objectives · forecast, variance, deficit · recovery options · advisor rules · add-department impact preview
Daily	Today's focus · next-step engine with reasons and Ignore · current / next / optional · quick actions (time, comment, screenshot, child, bug) · unfinished carry-over · replan from today · logging table · quick capture · Focus mode with timer · low-energy day · capture key
Reading	Fonts: system, Atkinson Hyperlegible, OpenDyslexic · text size · line and letter spacing · dark, warm and paper themes · calm labels · reduced motion · "Break it down" step suggestions
Time	Time entries with day, timestamp and note · totals by day / type / department / item · today, last 7 days, whole project or custom range · hours-per-day chart against your daily capacity · corrections by negative entries
Views	Dashboard · Today · Planner · Timeline (days / weeks) · Backlog · Department list / kanban (drag) / checklists with filters and sort · Bugs · Search with 11 filters · Time log · Reports
Reports	Weekly report (progress, health, planned vs actual, completed, new, bugs, blockers, departments, critical path, changes, risks, recommendations) · Markdown, HTML, print/PDF, CSV, JSON · plan vs actual by department · activity stream

Data	Several projects side by side (switch, open, delete to trash) · auto-save with .bak · export / import JSON · schema upgrades from older versions · reset to defaults or sample · templates saved with the project · local only
Claude	Local connector (MCP) for Claude Code and the Claude desktop app: create projects, add departments, create tasks / assets / bugs, update, set status and progress, log time, comment, run the planner, read health, next steps, today, search
Keyboard	1–6 screens · / search · + add department · F focus · C capture · Esc close · Enter to save/log · paste image

Crucible 0.7 · © 2026 Armaan · All rights reserved. Compiled builds are shared for personal use; the software is not open source.

21 · Several projects

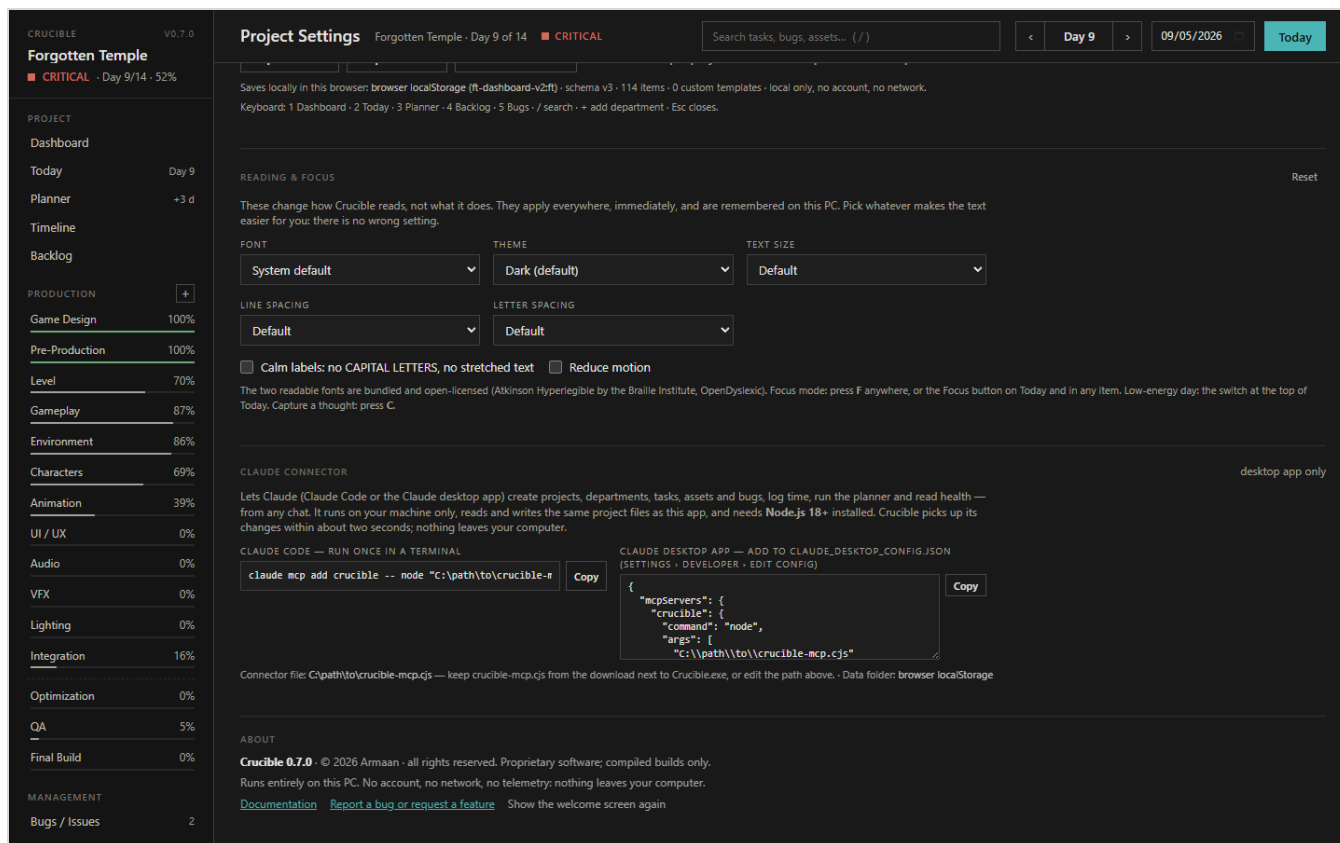
The screenshot shows the 'Project Settings' page for a project named 'Forgotten Temple'. The interface is dark-themed. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: Dashboard, Today, Planner, Timeline, Backlog, and a list of production tasks (Game Design, Pre-Production, Level, Gameplay, Environment, Characters, Animation, UI / UX, Audio, VFX, Lighting, Integration, Optimization, QA, Final Build) and management tasks (Bugs / Issues). The main content area is titled 'Project Settings' and includes a search bar, a table of project items, and several configuration sections. The table shows one project item: 'Forgotten Temple' with 114 items and a last update of 9/14. Below the table is a 'DATA' section with buttons for 'Export JSON', 'Import JSON', 'Reset to defaults', 'Reset to sample project', and 'Add template to each department'. The 'READING & FOCUS' section contains settings for font, theme, text size, line spacing, and letter spacing. The 'CLAUDE CONNECTOR' section provides instructions and code snippets for integrating with Claude.

Project Settings → Projects: everything stored on this PC.

Crucible keeps as many projects as you like, each in its own folder. One is open at a time.

- **Create:** Project Settings → **New project...** (the wizard). The new project is added and opened; the one you were in stays as it was.
- **Switch:** click the project name at the top of the rail — it becomes a drop-down as soon as you have more than one project — or press **Open** in the Projects table. Item windows of the previous project can stay open; they keep saving to that project.
- **Delete:** the Projects table. The folder is moved to **projects_trash**, so nothing is lost. The open project can only be deleted when another one exists.
- Import JSON, Reset to defaults and Reset to sample still act on the **open** project.

22 · The Claude connector



Project Settings → Claude connector: copy one of the two snippets.

The download contains a second file, **crucible-mcp.cjs**. It is a small local program (an MCP server) that lets Claude work inside your Crucible data from any chat: "create a 60-day asset-pack project with these departments", "log these playtest notes as bugs with severity", "what should I do today?", "log 2 hours on the altar model". Claude Code and the Claude desktop app both support it.

Setup

- 1 Install **Node.js 18 or newer** (nodejs.org) if you do not have it. Claude Code already needs it.
- 2 Keep **crucible-mcp.cjs** next to **Crucible.exe**. The Settings box shows "connector file found" when it is in place.
- 3 **Claude Code**: copy the first snippet and run it once in a terminal. **Claude desktop app**: copy the second snippet into Settings → Developer → Edit config (*claude_desktop_config.json*) and restart the app.
- 4 Ask Claude for something. It sees the projects on this PC and works on the current one unless you name another.

What it can do

READ

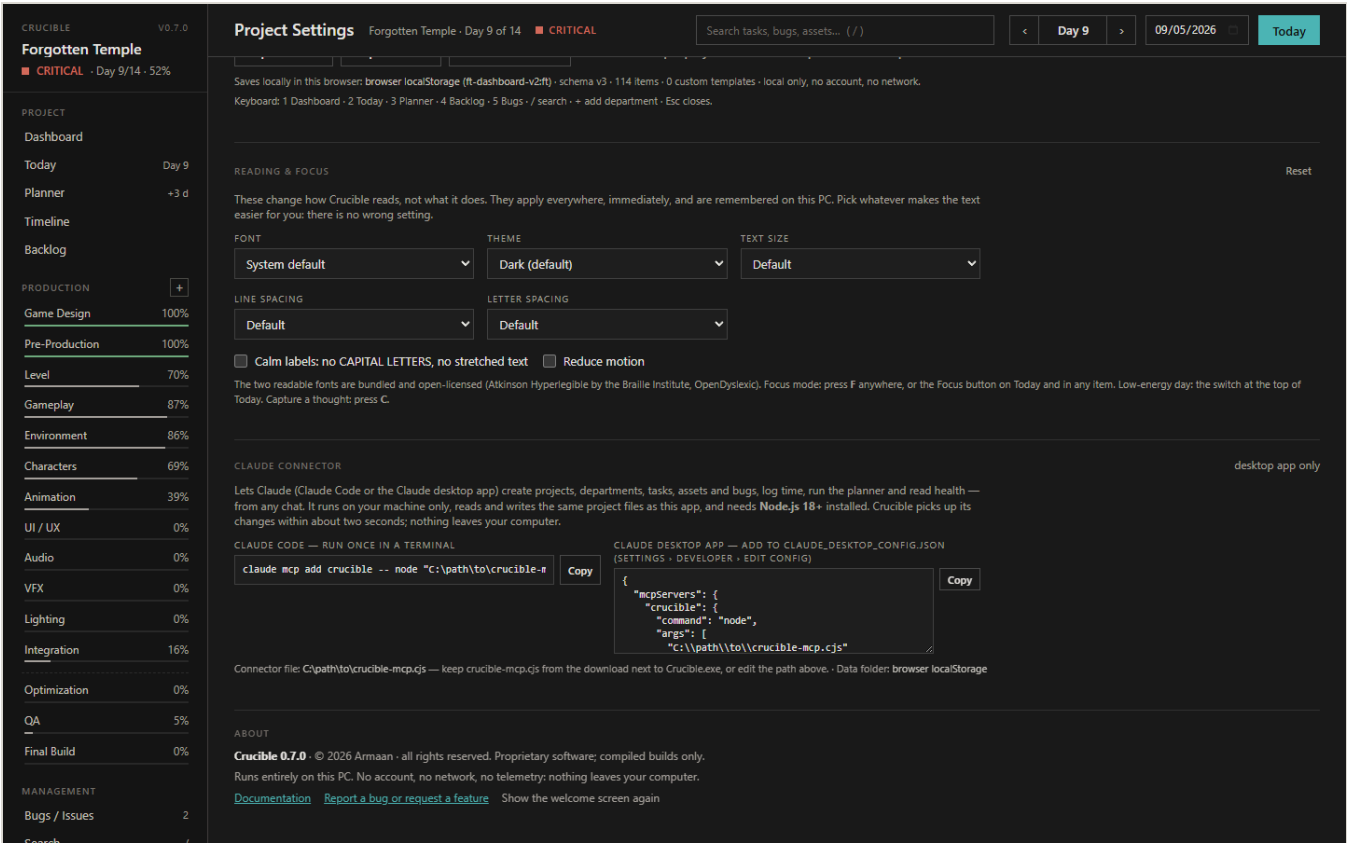
WRITE

list projects · project summary ·	create project (departments from the description, or ones you name, with pipeline
search items · one item with	templates and first assets) · add department (returns the plan impact) · create task
history · health and forecast ·	/ asset with pipeline / bug · update fields · set status · set progress · log time · add
next steps · today's ranked work ·	comment · run the planner (open or all)
recommended departments	

How it stays safe

- Everything runs on your machine. The connector reads and writes the same project files as the app; no server, no account, nothing leaves the PC.
- Every change it makes is written into the item history with author **Claude**; items it creates carry the tag **via-claude**, so you can search for them.
- Crucible notices the file change within about two seconds and reloads. If you were typing at that exact moment, the app keeps the file's version and tells you.
- The connector cannot delete projects or items.

23 · Reading & focus: fonts, themes, Focus mode, low-energy days



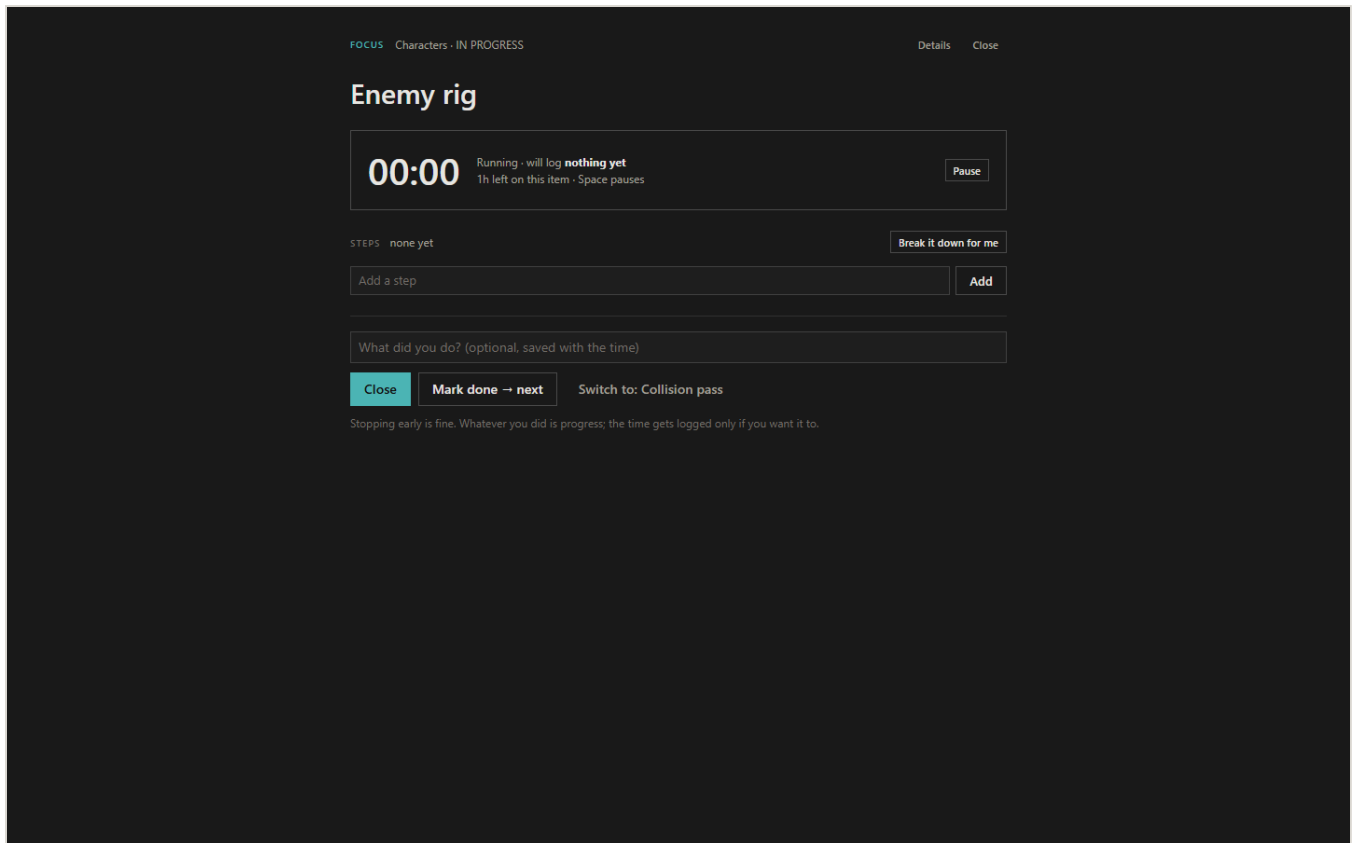
Project Settings → Reading & focus. Every choice applies at once, everywhere, and is remembered on this PC.

Crucible is built to be usable on days when reading is hard and days when starting is hard. None of this changes what the app does with your project; it changes how it reads and how much of it you see at once. There is no wrong setting.

Reading preferences (Project Settings → Reading & focus)

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Font	System default , Atkinson Hyperlegible (letters that are hard to confuse: l / I / 1, O / 0) or OpenDyslexic (heavier bottoms so letters do not flip). Both are bundled, no download.
Theme	Dark (default), Warm (dark with softer contrast and less blue) or Paper (light, cream background, for people who read better on light surfaces).
Text size	Scales the whole app from 90 % to 145 %. Windows and tables reflow.
Line spacing · Letter spacing	More air between lines and between letters. Often the single most helpful change for dyslexia.
Calm labels	Turns off the CAPITAL-LETTER section labels and the stretched tracking. Same words, lower volume.
Reduce motion	No transitions or animations.

Focus mode



Focus mode: one item, its steps, a timer. Nothing else on screen.

Press **F** anywhere, or click **Focus** on Today or inside any item. The screen shows one item only: its title, description, steps and a running timer. Space pauses the timer. What you can do from there:

- **Tick steps** as you go. "Just the next one" shows the single step to do now.
- **Break it down for me** (when an item has no steps): adds five or six small, ordered steps suited to the item type: tasks, bugs or assets. Edit them freely; they are yours.
- **Log & close**: the time on the timer is rounded to the nearest quarter hour and logged with your note. Under three minutes logs nothing. **Close** or **Esc** leaves without logging.
- **Mark done → next**: finishes the item (logging the time first) and moves straight to the next best item.
- **Switch to**: jumps to the next best item without finishing this one.

Low-energy day

The switch at the top of Today. When it is on, Today hides the numbers, the forecast, the unfinished list and the table, and shows **one small thing**: the item with the least time left that fits in about half an hour (or the smallest item overall). **Something else** rotates to the next candidate; **Start in Focus** opens it in Focus mode. "Show everything anyway" brings the full screen back for the moment; the switch stays on until you turn it off. Doing that one thing counts as a full day.

Capture

Press **C** on any screen, type the thought, press **Enter**. It goes to the backlog, unscheduled, so it is out of your head without becoming today's problem. Sort it later from the Backlog.

Break it down (item window)

In the item window, Steps tab, **Break it down** proposes steps in a text box, one per line. Change, reorder or delete lines, then **Add these steps**. Pasting your own list works the same way; numbering and bullets are stripped.